CARD, CARD NEW, MULTI-ROW CARD, AND KPI VISUALS IN POWER BI

Visuals in Power BI play a central role in transforming raw datasets into meaningful insights. Among them, **Card visuals**—in their various forms—are some of the simplest yet most powerful elements for summarizing key metrics. Cards help report consumers quickly identify vital numbers such as total revenue, average profit, last transaction date, number of orders, or any KPI (Key Performance Indicator) relevant to a business.

In Power BI, Microsoft provides several card-type visual templates:

1. **Card (Standard Card Template)**
2. **Card New (Modern Card Visual)**
3. **Multi-Row Card**
4. **KPI Visual**

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Each serves different formatting and display purposes. The following detailed explanation will walk you through how they work, how to configure them, and when to use each one.

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1. Standard Card Visual in Power BI

The **standard card** is the most commonly used visual to display a **single, aggregated value**. It is widely used for summarizing quantitative and qualitative information.

1.1 Purpose of the Standard Card

- Displays a **single measure or summarised value**.
- Ideal for KPIs such as:
    - Total Sales
    - Total Profit
    - Average Sales

    - Last Order Date
    - Distinct Customer Count
    - Total Orders
- Helps business users immediately see important metrics at a glance.
- Similar to a *business card* where essential information is highlighted.

1.2 Adding and Configuring a Standard Card

After adding a Card visual, you assign a field to it. For example:

Step 1: Add the Card template to the canvas.
Step 2: Reduce or adjust the size to fit your layout.
Step 3: Drag the **Sales** field into the card.

The card automatically aggregates the value—by default, it performs **SUM** on numerical fields.
So, if the total sales is **50.24K**, the card will display:

50.24K
Sum of Sales

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1.3 Formatting Options

Power BI allows flexible formatting options for Card visuals.

a. Category Label (the label under the number)

- By default, the text like **"Sum of Sales"** appears below the number.
- To remove it:
    1. Go to **Format your Visual**
    2. Open **Category Label**
    3. Switch it **Off**

This is useful when you want the card to look clean, especially when a proper title is added.

b. Adding a Title Above the Number

To display a title such as **"Total Sales"**:

1. Go to **Format → General**
2. Turn on **Title**
3. Enter text, e.g., "Total Sales"
4. Adjust:
    - Font size
    - Alignment
    - Font color
    - Position
5. Resize the card so the title and value align well.

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c. Adding a Divider

- Enables a thin horizontal line separating the title and the value.
- Helps visually distinguish the two components.

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d. Background Colors and Borders

You can customize:

- **Background color** of the entire card
- **Rounded corners**
- **Borders**
- **Transparency**
- **Shadow**

This enhances readability and aesthetic appeal.

1.4 Display Units and Decimal Places

Card visuals allow formatting of numeric values.

Example: Your sales appear as **50.24K**, but you want to show it in **millions** or **without units**.

Steps:

1. Go to **Format → Callout Value**
2. Under **Display Units** choose:
    - None
    - Thousands
    - Millions
    - Auto
3. Control decimal points by turning **"Value Decimal Places"** off or setting a number.

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This helps when displaying corporate KPIs following a specific reporting style.

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2. Using Card to Display Qualitative (Non-Numeric) Values

Cards are not limited to numbers—they can also showcase text values such as:

- Latest Date of Sale
- First Date
- Category Name
- Customer Name
- Most Recent Order Status

Example: Displaying the Last Date of Sales

1. Add a Card visual.
2. Drag the **Date** field into it.
3. By default, the card shows **Earliest** date.
4. Click on the dropdown of the field → Choose **Latest**.

This allows the card to show the most recent transaction date.

Improving Visual Consistency with Format Painter

Power BI's **Format Painter** allows you to copy formatting from one card to another.

Steps:

- Select the card with the desired formatting
- Click **Format Painter**
- Click the new card

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This applies:

- Title style
- Background color
- Border
- Font size
- Alignment

This ensures uniformity across all KPIs.

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3. Displaying Multiple Aggregations: Average, Min, Max, Count, etc.

When you drag a numeric field (like Sales), the card defaults to **Sum**.
You can change this using the dropdown next to the field:

Available Options:

- Sum
- Average
- Minimum
- Maximum
- Count
- Count Distinct
- Standard Deviation
- Variance
- Median
- Percentage of Total

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Example: Displaying Average Sales

1. Select the Sales card
2. Click the field dropdown
3. Choose **Average**

If total sales = 50,240 and orders = 100, the card displays:

502.4
Average Sales

Similarly, you can create cards for:

- Standard Deviation
- Minimum Sales
- Maximum Sales
- Distinct Customer Count

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4. Card for Displaying Categorical Counts (e.g., Total Orders)

Suppose your dataset has an **Order ID** field representing each order.

To find the total number of orders:

1. Add a Card visual
2. Drag **Order ID** into it
3. Change summarization:
    - From **First** (default)
    - To **Count Distinct**

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This gives the exact number of unique orders.

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5. Card New (Modern Card Visual)

Power BI introduced **Card New**, a modern card template that combines the functionality of classic cards and multi-row cards.

5.1 Purpose

- Designed to display **multiple KPIs inside a single card visual**.
- Supports vertical or horizontal layouts.
- Offers improved formatting and grouping functions.

5.2 Features of Card New

- **Supports multiple measures inside one card**
- Better design controls
- Group title (e.g., “KPIs”)
- Spacing control between KPIs
- Divider options
- Background image support
- Enhanced border and rounding effects

5.3 Example Usage of Card New

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Suppose you want to display:

- Total Sales
- Total Profit
- Average Sales

Instead of creating three separate card visuals, you can:

1. Add **Card New**
2. Add multiple fields into *“Fields”*
3. Arrange them horizontally or vertically
4. Group them under a common title

This reduces clutter on dashboards.

5.4 Handling Categorical Variables in Card New

Card New behaves similarly to traditional cards:

- Categorical fields show first/last values
- Numeric fields show aggregated measures

You can still change summarization options like:

- Count
- Distinct Count
- Latest
- Earliest

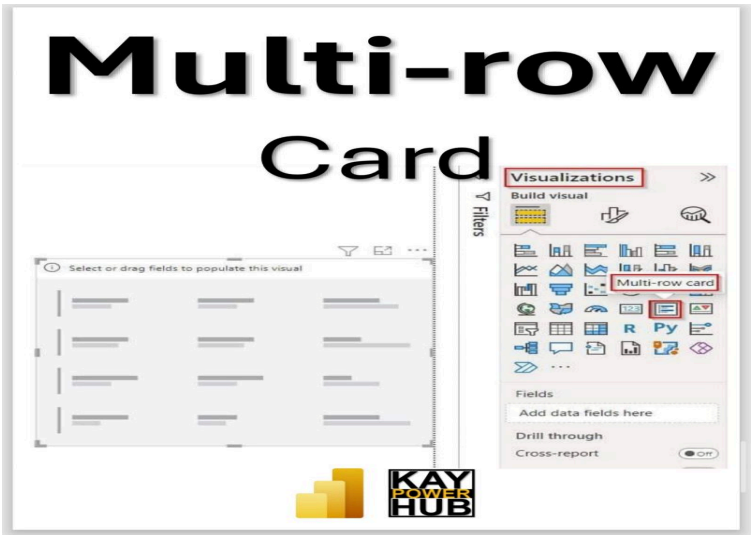
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6. Multi-Row Card

The Multi-Row Card was originally designed to show multiple measures in a stacked layout.

6.1 Purpose

- Display multiple KPIs or categorical summaries
- Each value shown in a separate row
- Example:
    - Total Sales
    - Total Profit
    - Average Sales
    - Distinct Orders



However, **Card New** now replaces much of this functionality.

6.2 Behavior Compared to Card New

- Multi-Row Card displays values in a simple row-based layout.
- It does not offer modern formatting like:
    - Group title
    - Modern background styles
    - Grid layouts
    - Improved spacing

Card New is more flexible, but Microsoft still retains Multi-Row Card for backward compatibility.

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7. KPI Visual

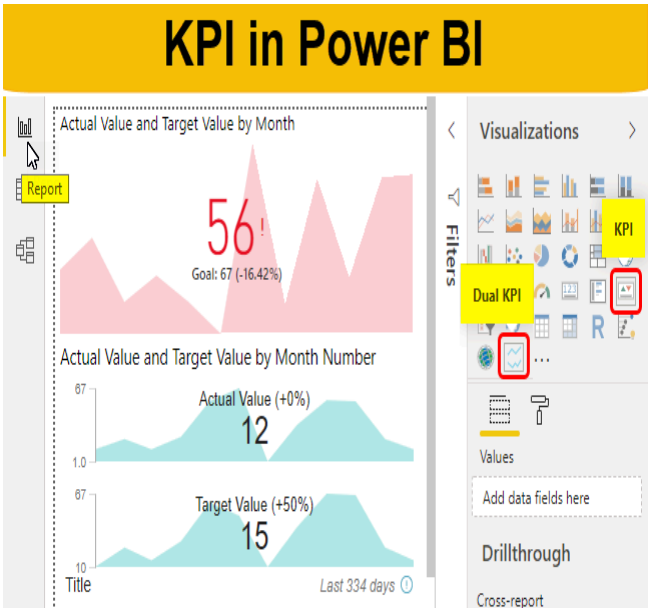
The **KPI visual** is different from the card visuals.
It is specifically designed to show **goal vs achievement**, along with **trend over time**.

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7.1 Purpose of KPI Visual

It provides:

- A main metric value
- A comparison with a target
- A trend line over time
- Color-coded highlighting based on performance



Used in business dashboards for:

- Daily sales monitoring
- Performance vs target
- Growth tracking

- Customer acquisition vs goal

7.2 Components of KPI Visual

A KPI visual requires:

1. **Value** – the main measure
2. **Trend Axis** – typically a Date field
3. **Target** – goal value or target measure

7.3 Example Usage

If you convert a card to a KPI visual:

1. Add **Sales** to Value
2. Add **Date** to Trend Axis
3. KPI now displays:
    - Latest day's sales
    - Trend line showing sales over time
    - Comparison against a target (if added)

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Example:

- Total sales = 50.24K
- Last date sale = 600.3
- Target per day = 700

The KPI may show:

- **Red** (if below target)

- **Green** (if above target)

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8. Comparison of Card Templates

Feature	Standard Card	Card New	Multi-Row Card	KPI Visual
Single Metric	✔	✔	✖	✔
Multiple Metrics	✖	✔	✔	✖
Trend Over Time	✖	✖	✖	✔
Supports Target	✖	✖	✖	✔
Modern Design	Moderate	Excellent	Basic	Moderate
Best Use	Quick metric display	Compact KPI grouping	Multi-row summaries	Goal tracking

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9. Best Practices for Using Cards in Dashboards

1. **Use consistent formatting**
    - Font sizes
    - Colors
    - Border styles
    - Background themes
2. **Use meaningful titles**
   Instead of "Sum of Sales," use:
    - Total Sales
    - Revenue Generated
3. **Avoid clutter**
   Use Card New to combine many KPIs into a single visual.

4. **Use KPI visual when tracking performance over time.**

5. **Align all card visuals properly**
   Consistent spacing improves readability.

6. **Use display units wisely**

   - Use “Millions” for financial metrics
   - Avoid overcrowded numbers

7. **Use Format Painter to save time**
   Keeps all cards visually aligned.

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10. Summary

Card visuals, Card New, Multi-Row Card, and KPI visual templates form the backbone of KPI reporting in Power BI. Their effective use allows businesses to communicate critical metrics clearly and aesthetically.

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- **Standard Card** is perfect for single metrics.
- **Card New** consolidates multiple KPIs elegantly.
- **Multi-Row Card** is for older multi-metric layouts.
- **KPI Visual** helps in comparing performance against targets and identifying trends.

Each has a specific use case, but together, they enrich analytical dashboards and deliver insights with clarity and impact.